

The topic I have chosen is transitioning from homelessness to employment and housing. The reason I chose this topic is because of the increase in homelessness in Clark County. According to 8newsnow a report from May 9, 2024, there are 7,928 homeless people in Clark County an increase of 56% percent. There are laws to address the problem like the controversial camping ban passed in 2020, that banned homeless people from occupying downtown areas. The law penalizes people with a 1,000-dollar fine or six months of jail time (Reporter, Guardian Staff). This just gives homeless people a bigger hurdle to jump through if they have a criminal record. The problem can be addressed with new opportunities for housing and expanding existing working programs. An example of such a program is the Second Chance Employment Program in Las Vegas (Homeless Services). The program provides legal, educational, and housing services. If we address this problem through a lens of aid and support, we will grow a labor force to reinforce our local businesses.

I will use local statistics reporting about the amount of unhoused people in Clark County. I will use the success rate reported by labor programs such as Second Chance Employment. I will also use how much money the city uses to house a single prisoner to make a point on how imprisoning homeless people is expensive and counterproductive since when they complete their time, they will still have nowhere to go. The statistics that I gather will be used to make the point that it is better to support our unhoused population than to criminalize their existence. In the most basic of macro economics class, we are taught that an educated workforce is essential for long term economic growth. We are wasting business opportunities when we discard thousands of capable laborers because of their housing status.

Works Cited

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Reporter, Guardian Staff. "Las Vegas Bans Homeless People From Sleeping on the Street." *The Guardian*, 7 Nov. 2019, www.theguardian.com/us-news/2019/nov/07/las-vegas-homeless-sleeping-street-ban.